



Here's Where The Action Is

I just wanted to share a little thought with fellow *Digit* magazine readers. My thoughts are intended as follows: I'm trying to be as precise in expressing myself as possible. I hope you like my idea and publish this e-mail to make readers aware of the Granular Linux Project. In the initial days of my experimentation with Linux, it delighted me, enlightened me, to an extent that I eventually ended up creating a distribution.

About eight months ago, Granular Linux began its journey under the Granular Project. In due course of time, Team Granular has grown from a single member to a small team of six to seven members from across the globe.

Based on PCLinuxOS, this distribution has always been touted as the "distro for newbies." Although nowadays we have a lot of distros that are very easy to use including Ubuntu, Mandriva, and PCLOS, these have some things that give them a bit of geeky feel, which we intend to do away with in Granular. It's the endeavour of Team Granular to make it the easiest-to-use distro on the planet. This is not possible through a very small team. Granular is intended to be completely community-oriented. Development within a community is fast; a community understands the needs of others better, support from the community is best, and moreover, a community helps others grow and learn fast.

With this ideology in mind, I urge the Indian talent to come ahead and form a community that would fulfil the goals set for Granular and also make India proud by giving the world's first-ever community-based native Indian distro free of cost. This is in the spirit of the open source revolution that other countries already support. Why just be a part of the revolution—why not create one?

For more information, please check

out www.granularproject.org. Granular on DistroWatch: www.dirstrowatch.com/granular.

Anurag Bhandari

Dear Anurag

Congratulations on your efforts thus far. I can only encourage you; what you are proposing sounds exciting to say the least. And the least I can do is publish this as the first letter in this section of the magazine.

Considering our reach, I believe you will get more than a few responses. Do keep me updated on what's going on, and whether we made a difference.

— Executive Editor

The Best Ever...?

Dear Team Digit,

Let me first ask you a question. Was last month's issue the best *Digit* ever published? I think it really was. But let me thank you for also publishing the *Fast Track to Apple*. You fulfilled a long-term request of mine there.

The whole magazine was indeed a masterpiece. I'll compare it to the Linux kernel, which is the greatest masterpiece. Like the Linux kernel, the magazine was indeed valid for all the platforms. You didn't miss Linux, you didn't miss Mac, you didn't miss Vista, and, of course, you didn't miss XP. It was also nice to see *Tips & Tricks* on Linux and torrents.

The laptop test was quite impressive. But instead of categorising them into the lifestyle etc. sections, I suggest you sort them into price-wise sections the next time you do a shoot-out. One thing I don't understand is, why didn't you feature Macbooks in the laptop test? The Macbook model could have been included in the home series, and the Macbook Pros would be in the Performance segment. You could have even tested them by loading Windows XP or Vista on them via the Boot Camp utility.

Reading the history of Apple was quite interesting. But the thing that stood out was the operating system Mac OS X. The coverage of the iPhone was exhaustive. Did you really get your hands on the iPhone?

I used to save Web pages from the Apple site on my computer to read them again and again. But even those Web pages could not provide me with the information this little book did.

A big thank you for providing us with the Fedora 7 distribution. I was really in need of Fedora as I'm preparing for my

RHCE certification. Hey... wait a minute... why don't you guys publish a little article on the scopes of various certifications in the IT field? What are the scopes for our careers if we undergo MCSE, RHCE, CNE, etc. courses? It would be of great help to your young readers (which are the majority of your readers) and also to the retired citizens, who would like to do more after retiring from their jobs.

Thanking you in anticipation!

Tarun Brari

Hi Tarun,

It's good to see you writing to us after you submitted an article for our *Sixth Sense* issue. You really seem to be an avid reader. Let me answer a couple of your questions—first, about our laptop categorisations: I do of course know India is a price-sensitive market, but if a reader is to look only at price, he would tend to miss out on the usability factor—which, in my opinion, is paramount. About Macbooks, the two-pronged answer is that (a) they are expensive, so not too many readers would be interested; (b) not too many readers are comfortable with non-Windows OSes—yet; we have tried to rectify this situation via our *Fast Track*; (c) Macs are in a class of their own, and would not blend well in a comparison test; and (d) the few who do know and love Macs do not really need benchmarks—they already know what Mac to buy!

We really did get our hands on an iPhone, and finally, yes, we intend to publish an article on certifications—or something along those lines—soon.

— Executive Editor

Die, Pirates!

I live in New Delhi which is the heart of India. And the heart of Delhi is Connaught Place, which is the centre of piracy. In Palika Bazaar, every shop vander offers pirated CDs without any fear. I have a genuine version of XP which is costly, but there I found I can get it for as low as Rs 60 without any bargains. I think companies like Microsoft, Adobe, Corel, and Autodesk are not worried about piracy because everyone knows that pirated CDs are available there; don't these companies know these facts?

I think piracy can only be stopped after lowering the prices of genuine software, which as far as I know, seems impossible. The only light I can see are the movies which have started to retail at as low as Rs 39, and open source software like VLC Media Player.

Akash Yadav
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